

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 665

By Reeves

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Jim Tracy for his exemplary service to the State of Tennessee and his fellow citizens.

WHEREAS, Jim Tracy has proven himself to be a noble public servant throughout his many endeavors in the local, state, and federal levels of government; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Tracy was a valuable member of the Tennessee Senate for thirteen years (2005-2017) before resigning to serve in President Donald J. Trump's first administration as State Director of United States Department of Agriculture (USDA) Rural Development for Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, he established lifelong ties to agriculture and the land while growing up in West Tennessee, where his father was a county extension agent; Mr. Tracy was active in 4-H and on the family farm as a youth, and he later taught agricultural education at the high school level; and

WHEREAS, as USDA State Director, Mr. Tracy used his real-life agricultural experience, legislative skills, and good judgment "to oversee rural development programs in a customer-focused manner to restore prosperity in rural Tennessee"; and

WHEREAS, a strong advocate for rural and agriculture issues during his time in the Senate, he chaired the body's Transportation and Safety Committee, served as Speaker Pro Tempore, and was a member of the Commerce and Labor and Education committees; and

WHEREAS, in 2007, he astutely guided to passage landmark legislation that prohibited smoking in public indoor places, state facilities, and places of employment, a great accomplishment that helped improve the health of Tennesseans; and

WHEREAS, during his tenure in the General Assembly, Senator Tracy worked with purpose and conviction to cut taxes, reduce spending, and make Tennessee State government

more transparent and efficient, while providing sound leadership on legislative issues vital to his constituents and the State as a whole; and

WHEREAS, prior to his service in the Senate, Jim Tracy was a highly influential figure in his community, serving on the Bedford County's Board of Education, Chamber of Commerce, and Economic Development and Tourism Committee; and

WHEREAS, in January 2021, Mr. Tracy returned to State government when he was appointed by Governor Bill Lee as a senior advisor for the Department of Commerce and Insurance; and

WHEREAS, a graduate of the University of Tennessee at Martin, Jim Tracy operated his own small business for twenty-four years, working as an insurance agent, and was a highly regarded NCAA basketball official for ten years; and

WHEREAS, throughout his career, Jim Tracy has demonstrated the positive difference one person can make in a community through dedication and diligence; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Tracy is a man of integrity who has never sacrificed his values for expediency, and we would do well to follow his example of courage and compassion in public service; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Jim Tracy for his exemplary service to the State of Tennessee and his fellow citizens and extend to him our best wishes for much continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.